

PREMIUM MAYHEM, BUDGET PATIENCE



A rant on Borderlands 4's botched PC launch

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If you'd told me in 2012 that the splashiest Borderlands news of 2025 would be about stutters, spyware accusations, and a CEO telling players to "code your own engine," I'd have coughed up a Golden Key. Yet here we are: a beloved looter-shooter riding historic player highs while tripping over the very basics. This is a masterclass in how many spinning plates it takes to make a modern blockbuster actually feel good – and how quickly it all shatters when a few wobble.

DAY 1 MAYHEM WASN'T FUN

On PC, Borderlands 4 launched like a Tediore grenade with the pin reinserted upside-down: shader-compilation hitches, frequent crashes, and frame-time spaghetti even on monster rigs. Within hours, Steam user reviews skewed "mostly

negative"/"mixed," with complaint threads citing stuttering, instability and poor scaling on high-end hardware. PC Gamer and GamesRadar both chronicled the rough landing; meanwhile, Gearbox pushed a 2.7GB patch that helped some crashing but left stuttering and pacing issues stubbornly alive.

Wondering whether the built-in "Badass" preset is a meme at 4K? Tom's Hardware measured drops to the low-40s FPS even on bleeding-edge GPUs, pinning much of the pain on UE5's CPU-heavy Lumen/Nanite pipeline. Unless you love hitching, turn down the peacocking.

Gearbox did publish a PC troubleshooting guide – including shader pre-compilation expectations – which helped some users tame the hitching (others ballooned their driver shader cache just to keep frame-time dings at bay). Such voodoo needed in 2025 is... a mood.

CUTSCENES AT 30 FPS?

Nothing kills momentum like swapping from 90+ FPS gameplay to 30 FPS cutscenes with choppy pacing. Multiple reviews and user reports confirm cinematics hard-capped at

30, creating a jarring rubber-band between fights and story beats. For players who built rigs to feast on fluid motion, that 30-FPS film school homage feels more like a pop quiz you didn't study for.

"PREMIUM GAME MADE FOR PREMIUM GAMERS"

While the tech teams were firefighting, Gearbox CEO Randy Pitchford logged on – and poured nitro into the discourse. Across posts on X, he



argued that older or "too-old" PC hardware simply isn't up to BL4's ambitions; he warned pre-launch that the day-one patch wouldn't work miracles on under-spec systems; and, most infamously, he told one critic to "code your own engine and show us how it's done." Even if you think he's technically right in